Options that Change the Way the Interpreter Works

--backtrace-limit=num

Sets a limit on the number of lines of backtrace that are sent to standard error when the program sends a backtrace (when the program terminates unexpectedly, for example). The default value is -1, meaning unlimited backtrace.

-C directory

Changes working directory to directory before executing.

-d, --debug

Sets $DEBUG and $VERBOSE to true. This can be used by your programs to enable additional tracing.

--disable={FEATURE}

Disable one of the features described in on page 236

-Eex[:in], --encoding=ex[:in], external-encoding=encoding, internal-encoding=encoding

Specifies the default character encoding for data read from and written to the outside world. This can be used to set both the external encoding (the encoding to be assumed for file contents) and optionally the default internal encoding (the file contents are transcoded to this when read and transcoded from this when written). The format of the single *encoding* parameter is -E external, -E external:internal, or -E :internal.

-I directories

Specifies directories to be prepended to $LOAD_PATH ($:). Multiple -I options may be present. Multiple directories may appear following each -I, separated by a colon on Unix-like systems and by a semicolon on DOS/Windows systems.

-i [extension]

Edits ARGV files in place. For each file named in ARGV, anything you write to standard output will be saved back as the contents of that file. A backup copy of the file will be made if *extension* is supplied, as below.

```
$ ruby -pi.bak -e "gsub(/Perl/, 'Ruby')" *.txt
```

--jit, --mjit, --yjit

Enables one of the two Just In Time compilers available in Ruby. The C-based compiler can be enabled with --jit or --mjit, while the experimental Rust-based version can be enabled with --yjit. The JIT compilers are designed to improve program performance in long-running Ruby applications. Both compilers have several of their own command-line options.

-r library

Requires the named library or gem before executing.

-S

Looks for the program file using the RUBYPATH or PATH environment variable.

-s

Any command-line switches found after the program filename, but before any filename arguments or before a --, are removed from ARGV and set to a global variable named for the switch. In the following example, the effect of this would be to set the variable $opt to "electric":